

Question:

A 34-year-old woman presents to her OB/GYN with complaints of missing her last 3 periods as well as intermittent spontaneous milky-white nipple discharge bilaterally for the past 3 months. Vital signs are stable and within normal limits. Neurologic examination is without abnormality, including normal visual fields. Serology and MRI of the brain are ordered, with results pending. Which of the following sets of laboratory results would be expected in this patient?

Answer Choices:

- A. Decreased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH
- B. Decreased prolactin, increased FSH, increased LH
- C. Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, increased LH
- D. Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms of missing periods and milky-white nipple discharge are consistent with hyperprolactinemia. Hyperprolactinemia can be caused by a pituitary adenoma, which can compress the optic chiasm and cause visual field defects. The patient's visual field examination was within normal limits, but the MRI of the brain is ordered. Hyperprolactinemia is often associated with elevated prolactin levels. It can also lead to low FSH (follicle-stimulating hormone) and low LH (luteinizing hormone) levels, as these hormones are responsible for stimulating the pituitary to release prolactin. Therefore, the patient is likely to have decreased FSH and LH levels.

</think>

<answer> A. Decreased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH </answer>

